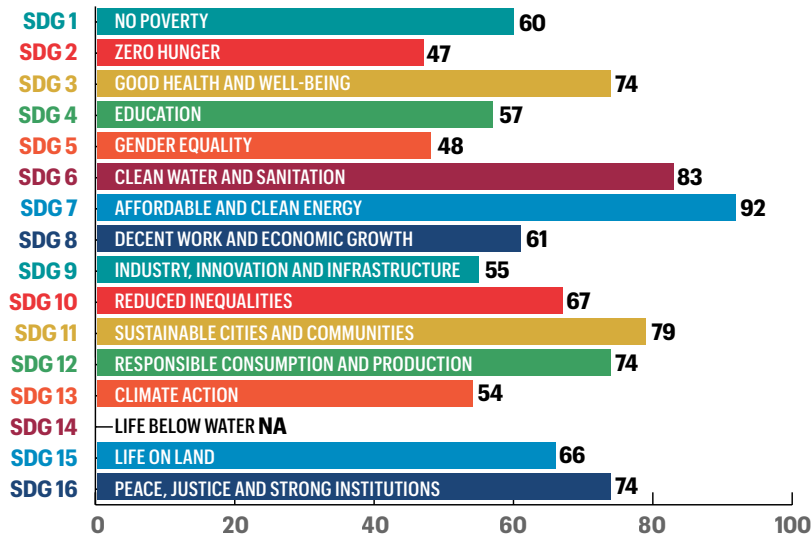


REPORT CARD

India's SDG-wise performance



NOTE PERFORMANCE ON EACH PARAMETER WAS SCORED ON A SCALE OF 100; NITI AAYOG DOES NOT SHARE DATA FOR SDG No. 17 **SOURCE** NITI AAYOG



“Countries must implement the \$500-billion per year Sustainable Development Goals stimulus plan. This requires immediate action towards addressing the high cost of debt”

DAVINDER SANDHU
CO-FOUNDER & CHAIRMAN,
PRIMUS PARTNERS



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South cooperation—as a critical strategy to accelerate the achievement of SDGs.

Kathel adds that the focus shouldn't exclusively be on government action; the private sector needs to be roped in too. “Invest in the capacities of the private sector and [civil society organisations] for successful SDG localisation. There is also a need to strengthen analytics to show who is getting left behind and why,” adds Kathel.

With a population of over 1.4 billion, India will be the driving force for the UN's SDG agenda. Moreover, while India will be the key to the success of this SDG programme, achieving the goals will also aid the country in its mission of becoming a developed nation.

“India's entire political and economic spectrum is focussed around the SDGs. After all, for an aspirational nation like India, the political leadership is committed to improving the standard of living of the people through increased and inclusive economic activities. The economic model too gets developed based on the choice, strength and purchasing power of consumers. The more purchasing power consumers have, the more they will spend on health, education, telecom and other requirements,” says Deepak Sood, Secretary General of industry body Assocham.

THE FINANCING CHALLENGE

Yet the efforts that India and other countries put in towards meeting the SDGs will be in vain if the crucial question of availability of resources and finance is not addressed. And if recent trends are anything to go by, this will be the big challenge. “Achieving the SDGs would require mobilisation and effective deployment of massive resources. As an example, for climate action alone, \$100 billion annually is needed in developing countries. The annual SDG financing gap for developing countries is estimated at \$4.2 trillion—up from



The upcoming SDG Summit promises to mark a new phase of accelerated progress towards the goals